

Airbnb offers cheap rental housing that two people who don't know each other can trust to live together (TED Talk, 2016). It exists as both a website and an app that are intuitive to use and reduce costs of what hotels usually offer. Based on preferences, it matches visitors with households that meet their needs. In addition to the app, they also launched a "Live There" campaign that is targeted towards offering unique experiences that typical tourists often miss. They identified a pain point: that people want to feel like a local in a new destination rather than being a slave to a massive tourist trap.

Family travelers usually prefer Airbnb because they're renting a house for as long as they wish at a cheaper price that hotels would charge each member separately. Whether asking questions before moving in or after, users can write in reviews that enhance the company's work to the mission.

- **Briefly describe the business environment in which the company operates.**
 - **Who are the company's main competitors? Are they large or small relative to the company? Can you find information about the company's market share in the markets it operates in?**
 - Airbnb's main competitors include Booking Holdings (who own [Booking.com](https://www.booking.com), Priceline, Agoda, and Kayak), Expedia Group (owner of Vrbo, [Hotels.com](https://www.hotels.com), Travelocity, Orbitz), Tripadvisor, and HomeToGo.
 - Booking Holdings is overall larger than Airbnb, as it dominates the broader online travel agency market, combining hotels, flights, and car and vacation rentals.
 - Expedia Group is also larger than Airbnb in total travel services, as it operates several brands across hotel, flight, and vacation rental sectors.
 - Tripadvisor competes against Airbnb through travel reviews and booking integrations, making it smaller than Airbnb in the short-term rental market.
 - Airbnb is one of the dominant companies in the global short-term rental market, controlling ~44% of the global short-term rental industry. In comparison, Expedia only holds around ~9%.¹
 - Regarding the online-booking technology market, Airbnb holds ~26-28% of the market share, behind Tripadvisor.²

¹<https://www.businessinsider.com/airbnb-calls-vrbo-desperate-for-billboard-about-hosts-ad-campaign-2025-3>

² <https://6sense.com/tech/reservation-and-online-booking/airbnb-airbnb-market-share>

- **Are there any other major players that the company interacts with (e.g., major suppliers, regulators, producers of complementary products)? Does it operate in a heavily regulated industry?**
- https://www.sec.gov/ix?doc=/Archives/edgar/data/0001559720/000155972026000004/abnb-20251231.htm#i5126a676aff44c5d86374aae8e5c24eb_19
 - Airbnb works with hosts to provide the real estate and experiences they offer to their guests. AirBnB Inc. then uses a website to connect guests with hosts - the hosts would be considered the suppliers of the product, or more accurately, the experience that Air BnB is selling.
 - AirBnB has intense requirements due to the safety needs of their customers and the trust-based system they created. Regulations required for all short-term rentals, and some stipulations for AirBnB's specific format, make it a very intensely regulated industry.
- **Does the company rely heavily on specific customers?**
 - Air BnB does not rely heavily on any specific customers, but rather relies on millions of hosts and guests from around the world. There is no specific customer that generates a large amount of the company's revenue. This being said Air BnB does rely on a strong network of trust between guest and host and needs a lot of host participation in order to thrive. A broad decline of host participation would greatly impact the revenue of the company. Generally, younger generations are those using Airbnb to "Live like a Local" and because there are more online interactions needed than booking a hotel.
https://matrixbcg.com/blogs/target-market/airbnb?srsId=AfmBOorW6NHLozVEePkwTqi_qjEzCIRqIWTrBCzvhPmfhxPr3XQGHQvH
- **What are the challenges and opportunities the industry is facing today? Are there significant industry trends that might affect the company's business in the future?**
- Since Covid-19 people have been travelling less
 - However, there has been a steady climb in numbers, with 50% of Americans travelling over the 25-26 holiday season
 - Though with this climb, people have been much more conservative, both **Trip Frequency** and **duration** have decreased
- Financial pessimism has been reaching higher-income levels than in years prior
 - If this more conservative/pessimistic trend spreads to enough consumers, it could be catastrophic
 - As of right now, there seems to be no continued spread or slowdown though

- Corporate travel is slowing
 - This should not affect Airbnb though
 - <https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/insights/industry/transportation/travel-hospitality-industry-outlook.html>
- War in Iran
 - More flight cancellations as well as increased price for tickets
 - Jet fuel prices have surged more than 120%
 - <https://www.morganlewis.com/pubs/2026/05/impacts-on-the-aviation-market-of-the-war-in-iran>
 - Not just international travel is slowing, but due to increased oil prices, road trips and other forms of international travel
 - <https://www.tabivista.com/blog/global-uncertainty-vacation-rental-bookings-2026/>
- **What is the ownership structure of the company?**
 - Breakdown
 - 1.14% % of Shares Held by All Insider
 - 88.67% % of Shares Held by Institutions
 - 89.69% % of Float Held by Institutions
 - yahoo finance
- Voting power
 - Airbnb has set up its stock ownership as a class structure. Class B common stock carries 20 votes per share, compared to one vote per share for Class A. This gives the founders more control relative to their economic ownership. Percent voting power:
 - Brian Chesky (CEO) 30.5%
 - Nathan Blecharczyk (CSO) 29.7%
 - Joseph Gebbia 19.0%
- Institutional owners
 - There are many institutional holders Blackrock and Vanguard leading in shares.

Appendix

Holder	Shares	Date Reported	% Out	Value
Blackrock Inc.	31.94M	Mar 31, 2026	7.64%	4,180,423,048
Vanguard Capital Management LLC	26.13M	Mar 31, 2026	6.25%	3,420,148,600
Harris Associates L.P.	19.16M	Mar 31, 2026	4.59%	2,507,761,600
State Street Corporation	17.73M	Mar 31, 2026	4.24%	2,320,744,844
Geode Capital Management, LLC	10.4M	Mar 31, 2026	2.49%	1,361,190,466
Morgan Stanley	10.43M	Mar 31, 2026	2.49%	1,364,471,639
AQR Capital Management, LLC	8M	Mar 31, 2026	1.91%	1,046,927,374
Vanguard Portfolio Management LLC	7.79M	Mar 31, 2026	1.86%	1,018,989,378
FMR, LLC	7.75M	Mar 31, 2026	1.85%	1,014,522,785
Invesco Ltd.	6.01M	Mar 31, 2026	1.44%	786,258,293

- **-Yahoo finance**